7.1.2.1 Timber Lintel

In olden days of construction, timber lintels were mostly used. But, now-a-days they are replaced by concrete lintels based on modern techniques. However in hilly areas still timber lintels are in use. The main disadvantage of timber lintels are (i) more expensive (ii) less durable (iii) non-fire resistant.



7.1.2.2 Stone Lintel

These are the most common type of lintel especially where stone is available in large quantities. The thickness of lintels are most important factor of its design. These are also provided over the openings in brick walls. Stone lintels are provided either single piece or multiple pieces.



7.1.2.3 Brick Lintel

When the opening is less than 1m and for lesser loads, brick lintels are used. The depth of brick lintel varies from 10cm to 20 cm depending upon the span. Bricks with frogs are most suitable than normal bricks because, frogs when filled with mortar gives more sheer resistance of end joints. Such lintel is known as joggled brick lintel.



7.1.2.4 Steel Lintel

If the super imposed loads are heavy and openings are large, we can go for steel lintels. These lintels consist of channel sections or rolled steel joists. Single steel section or combinations of two or more are used depending upon the requirement.



7.1.2.5 Reinforced Brick Lintel

If loads are heavy and span is greater than 1m, then reinforced brick lintels are useful. The depth of reinforced brick lintel should be equal to 10cm to 15 cm or multiple of 10 cm. The bricks are so arranged that 2 to 3 cm wide space is left in lengthwise between adjacent bricks for the insertion of mild steel bars for reinforcement. Then cement mortar(1:3) is used to fill up the gaps.

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